

Arshia “Ash” Alguneh

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EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA

Master of Science, Human Security and Geospatial Intelligence, GPA: 3.95/4.0

Los Angeles, CA

01/2025 – 12/2026

UNIVERSITY OF SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA

Bachelor of Arts, International Relations, GPA: 3.61/4.0

Los Angeles, CA

08/2021 – 05/2025

Study Abroad (AY: 2023-2024), London School of Economics and Political Science

Awards: Cum Laude, USC Dornsife Dean's List Spring 2023, Fall 2024, Spring 2025

EXPERIENCE

LOS ANGELES GEOSPATIAL SUMMIT

Los Angeles, CA

Lightning Talk Presenter

02/2026

- Briefed government and private-sector GEOINT professionals on national security implications and detection methodologies for identifying concealed foreign adversary ownership near U.S. critical infrastructure, condensing a year of NGA-CRADA research into a 5-minute talk with two teammates.

UNIVERSITY OF SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA, Spatial Sciences Institute

Los Angeles, CA

Researcher, NGA-Cooperative Research and Development Agreement (CRADA)

09/2025 – 05/2026

- Applied OSINT methodologies to develop standard operating procedures for tracing true ownership through allied-nation shell companies, producing a 7-step, multidisciplinary detection framework that addresses the challenge of revealing concealed foreign adversary land control near U.S. critical infrastructure
- Mapped 4,400+ critical infrastructure nodes across 3 states and 7 priority sectors, including regulatory buffer zones, establishing the foundation for foreign ownership analysis
- Created investigative visualizations and analytical reports using ArcGIS Pro to communicate geospatial intelligence findings to The Director of Counterintelligence at the NGA, enabling non-technical decision-makers to assess foreign investment threat patterns

UNIVERSITY OF SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA

Los Angeles, CA

Teaching Assistant, Foreign Policy Analysis (Fall 2025) | Terrorism and Counterterrorism (Spring 2026)

08/2025 – 05/2026

- Delivered 90-minute lecture on the Russo-Ukrainian conflict for Foreign Policy Analysis with less than 24 hours' notice, presenting analytical frameworks and guiding 30+ students through structured discussion of complex geopolitical material
- Mentored students through weekly office hours and assignment feedback, adapting explanations across comprehension levels and guiding critical examination of source material.

UNIVERSITY OF SOUTHERN CALIFORNIA

Los Angeles, CA

Faculty Research Assistant, Department of Political Science and International Relations

08/2024 – Present

- Conducted real-time OSINT monitoring during the June 2025 Israel-Iran military escalation, synthesizing Iranian state media, regional social media, and international news to provide evolving situational awareness updates that informed faculty-published op-eds on regional security dynamics under time-sensitive conditions
- Tracked U.S.-Iran nuclear negotiations during critical third-round talks in May 2025, monitoring actor positions, sequencing disputes, and external pressure tactics across English and Farsi-language sources to produce a comprehensive assessment of negotiation dynamics and likely outcomes

MIDDLE EAST INSTITUTE

Washington, D.C.

Research Intern for Dr. Ross Harrison, Iran Program

01/2023 – 06/2023

- Leveraged Farsi language proficiency and Iranian cultural knowledge to conduct comprehensive open-source research on Iranian foreign policy, producing a 202-page analytical report that directly informed *Decoding Iran's Foreign Policy* (IB Tauris, July 2025)
- Identified underreported patterns in Iran-Türkiye defense industrial cooperation, uncovering probable Turkish sanctions evasion and bringing findings to the principal investigator, informing additional research directions
- Developed expertise on Iranian foreign policy decision-making, military strategy, internal political dynamics, and covert operations across Middle East theaters through sustained analysis

VIRTUAL STUDENT FEDERAL SERVICE INTERNSHIP

Remote

Intern, US Consulate in Vancouver, Canada

08/2022 – 08/2023

- Applied conversational Farsi to facilitate a community member interview, corroborating publicly available information and identifying potential areas of concern for U.S. diplomatic interests
 - Drafted official State Department cables documenting diaspora dynamics and potential influence operation indicators, ensuring appropriate handling of sensitive unclassified information and adherence to foreign service reporting standards
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ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

HARD SKILLS: Foreign Policy Analysis, OSINT Research, Geographic Information Systems (ArcGIS: Pro, Online, Drone2Map, AllSource), Audio and Video Editing (Final Cut Pro)

FOREIGN LANGUAGES: Farsi (Speaking/Listening: Conversational | Reading/Writing: Basic | Heritage Speaker), French intermediate